WHAT IS A SECOND RENAISSANCE, METAMODERN APPROACH TO TECHNOLOGY

TECHNOLOGY & A SECOND RENAISSANCE

RUFUS POLLOCK & SYLVIE BARBIER – SEPTEMBER 2024

Life Itself

Hello & Welcome 👋

Life Itself is a collective seeding a second renaissance for a radically wiser, weller world.

We prioritize inner development and cultural change in the service of deep social change. We seek to be rigorous and grounded whilst integrating theory and practice.

We build hubs, do research, start businesses and engage in cultural activism.

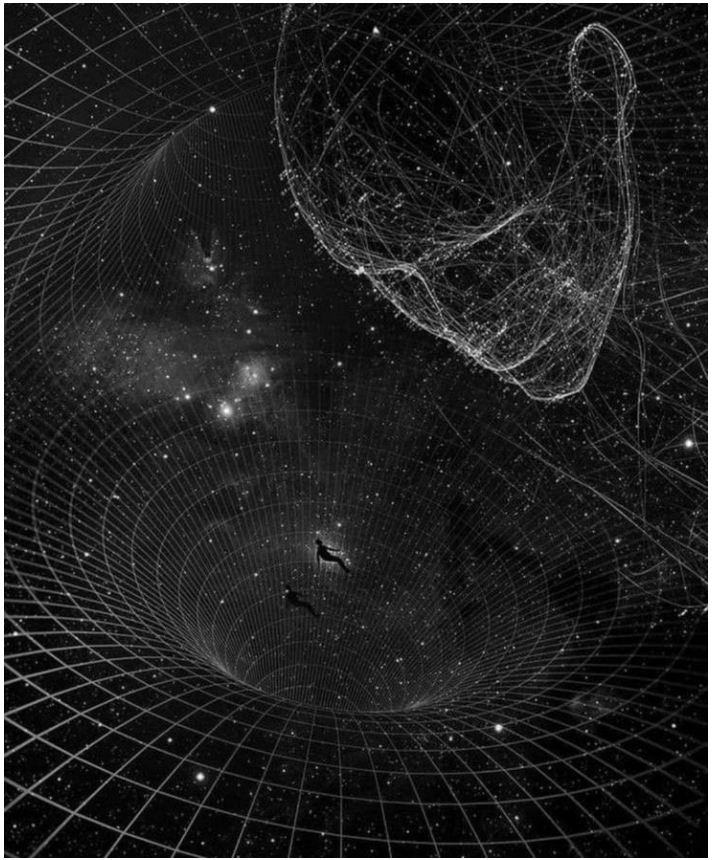
🌱 https://lifeitself.org
🌅 https://secondrenaissance.net
🌀 https://consciouscollectives.org

Life Itself

TECH AS GOD

OUR CURRENT RELATIONSHIP WITH TECH IS “TECH AS GOD”

- REVERENCE
- TRANSCENDENCE
- DEPENDENCE
- DEFERENCE



Life Itself

TECH: THE RUNNING HORSE

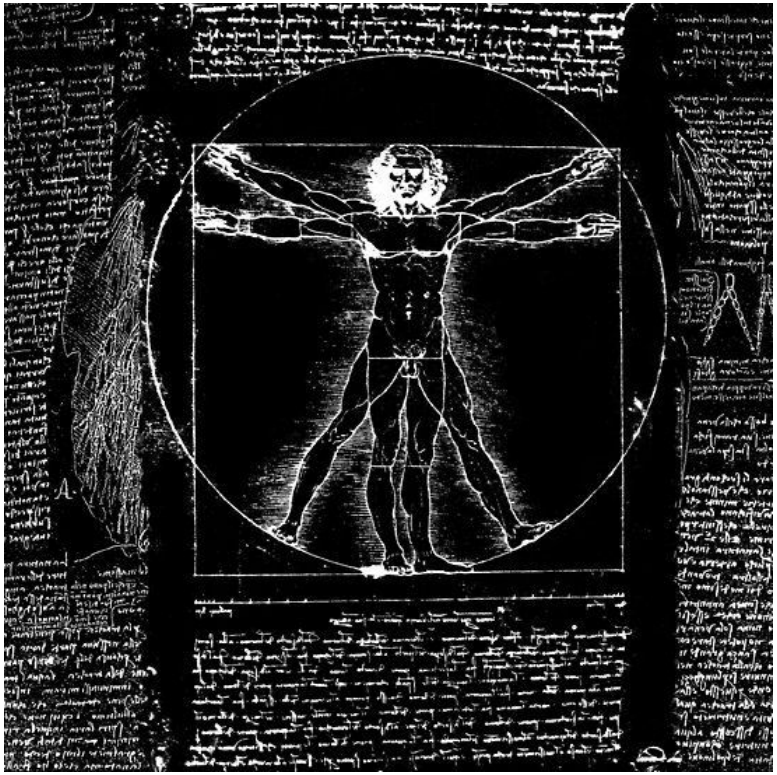
In Zen, there is a well-known story of a man on a horse, galloping swiftly down a road. Another man, standing on the side, shouts, “Where are you going?” and the rider replies, “I don’t know! Ask the horse!”

This story offers a mirror to our relationship with technology. The horse represents the pace of technological progress, moving faster than we can comprehend, and often in directions we have not considered.

Deference to tech: allowing it to shape us and our world at unprecedented pace and without real consideration.

Life Itself

How tech shapes our bodies, mind and culture



Life Itself

A SECOND RENAISSANCE, METAMODERN APPROACH TO TECH

WISDOM …

Key part of second renaissance, metamodern approach …

secondrenaissance .net

Second Renaissance

Whitepaper Art Ecosystem Course Wiki Events About News Chat

New ways of being, thinking and acting

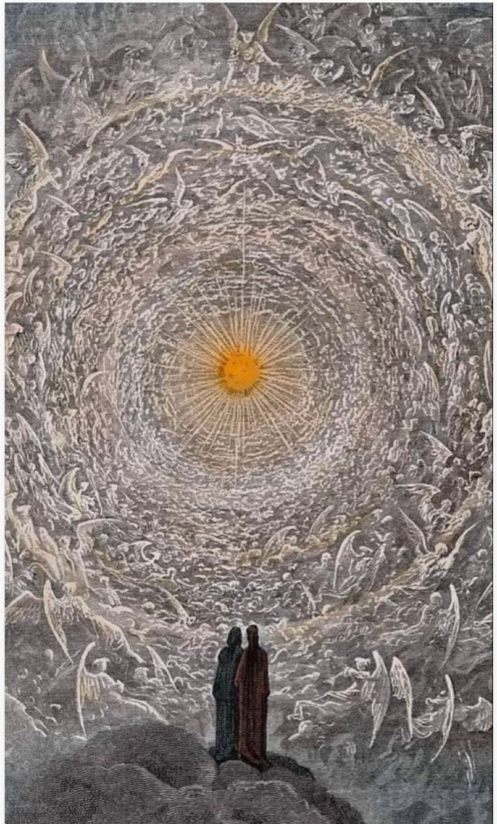
» **Inner growth** inner growth prioritized over material growth with a recognition of our potential to consciously evolve personally and collectively in multiple dimensions: to wake up, grow up, clean up, and show up.

» **Wisdom** A renewed cultivation of wisdom based in a recognition of the limits (and value) of reason, of the importance of the whole, and the value of a long term that includes all of the living.

» **Interbeing** Seeing clearly our profoundly interdependent relationship to each other and the planet in way that is regenerative, ecological and connecting.

» **Spirituality** Going beyond secularity to reintegrate spirituality and religion into collective life.

» **Beyond capitalism** A new economic system beyond capitalism and socialism, grounded in new ways to assess value.



Life Itself

RIDING THE HORSE WISELY

In the spirit of mindfulness and deep reflection, we can ask:

What does it mean to ride this horse wisely?

How do we cultivate a relationship with technology that is grounded in wisdom and compassion, rather than fear, greed, or ignorance?

Life Itself

SLOWING DOWN …

Because push to an extreme: tech is not well, as tech take the “being” out of human being away

Y Combinator

WISE INTENTION

When we create new tech, we need to ask: Where is this coming from? Is it motivated by wisdom and compassion, or is it driven by fear, greed, or ignorance? In our current model of technological development, particularly in places like Silicon Valley, the focus is on speed and efficiency. Entrepreneurs are encouraged to build prototypes quickly, to seek out markets, and to scale their businesses as rapidly as possible.

Y Combinator

A THOUGHT EXPERIMENT …

Imagine if the first days and weeks at an incubator like Y Combinator were spent in deep reflection. What if creators were asked to meditate on their intentions, to explore whether their innovations were coming from a place of love and compassion, ….

Life Itself

CULTIVATING WISDOM

COLLECTIVE WISDOM & COLLECTIVE ACTION PROBLEMS

CONCLUSION

A second renaissance, metamodern approach to tech integrates wisdom, mindfulness, and collective action.

By slowing down, reflecting deeply, and acting collectively, we can shape technology in ways that are aligned with our deep values and intentions.

This is the invitation of the present moment: to take the reins of the rushing horse, not to stop its progress, but to guide it wisely, with care and consideration for all.